# Arnie the Doughnut

## By Lori Keller

**NARRATOR:** Arnie turned out to be just the kind of doughnut he'd hoped he'd be – chocolate-covered with bright-colored candy sprinkles.

**ARNIE:** Look at all my sprinkles – there must be a million of them!

**BAKER:** *(stage whispers to audience)* Actually, there are only 135, but I'm not going to spoil it for him.

## INTRODUCTION

*Arnie is colorful, covered in sprinkles, and full of personality! He thinks life at the bakery is pretty sweet -- until he finds out that doughnuts aren't adopted, they're eaten.* ***Yikes!*** *But once the sprinkles have settled, Arnie's determined to prove he's more than just breakfast . . . he's best friend material!*

*Arnie the Doughnut by Lori Keller*

**NARRATOR:** He was made very early in the morning at the Downtown Bakery, "Home of the Best Doughnuts A-Round!"

**DONUT 1:** *(with a wiggly hula motion)* "A-Round?" Get it?

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**NARRATOR:** Arnie was proud to be one of the best. He knew that people all over town made special trips to his bakery to buy doughnuts of their very own. As Arnie sat on the tray, which had just been placed in the doughnut case, he took a moment to reflect on the amazing things that had happened to him that morning.

1 -- Cut into ring [in the] Ringy-Dingy Doughnut-making Thingy.

**ARNIE:** *(as if going down a slide)* Wheeeeee!

**NARRATOR:** 2 – Deep fried

**ARNIE:** *(doing the back stroke, swimming)* I'm soaking in boiling grease, but I love it!

**NARRATOR:** 3 – Cooled

**WAITER:** *(serving Arnie)* Your drink, sir!

**ARNIE:** *(taking a long sip through a straw)* Thank you!

**NARRATOR:** 4 – Iced

**ICER:** *(as if in a salon/stylist)* Who's that handsome doughnut?

**ARNIE:** *(admiring himself)* That's me!

**NARRATOR:** 5 – Sprinkled

**WORKER:** *(reading sign and putting on goggles)* CAUTION—Sprinkle Area. Must wear safety goggles!

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**NARRATOR:** 6 – Named

**ARNIE:** *(assuming a rap persona)* Whatever I'm named, I'm going to go by Cool Iced-D.

**NARRATOR:** Arnie looked around and saw all sorts of doughnuts sitting nearby.

**CINNAMON TWIST:** *(with an accent)* Cinnamon Twist!

**CHOCOLATE ZEBRA:** *(with another accent)* Chocolate Zebra

**SQUARE:** *(in a nerdy persona)* Square

**POWDERED:** *(another persona using a powder puff)* Powdered.

**LONG JOHN:** *(a pirate accent)* [Yo, ho ho!] Long John

**BEAR CLAW:** *(with a growling roar, and swipe of claws)* Bear claw!

**NARRATOR:** He tried to strike up a conversation with an apple fritter on the next tray over, but she didn't seem to want to talk.

**APPLE FRITTER:** *(giving him the cold shoulder)* Humffff!

**ARNIE:** It is rather early. Maybe she's not a morning doughnut.

**NARRATOR:** It was 6 am and the baker had just hung the OPEN sign in the window. Arnie was fascinated as he

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watched customers stream into the bakery. One by one, doughnuts were chosen, placed in paper bags and whisked away with their new owners. Some went by the dozen in giant boxes.

**ARNIE:** *(waving merrily)* Goodbye! Have a great trip! *(to audience)* This is so exciting! I wonder who will choose me?

**NARRATOR:** Just then, Arnie looked up and saw a man pointing right at him!

**ARNIE:** *(honored and excited)* Moi? *(he's lifted off the tray)*

**NARRATOR:** Before he could say another word, he was pulled from the tray and placed in a paper bag of his very own.

**SQUARE:** Good-bye, Arnie!

**CINNAMON TWIST:** We'll miss you!

**BAKER:** *(to customer)* Thank you, Mr. Bing. Have a nice day!

**APPLE FRITTER:** *(with tears)* I should have talked to him while I had the chance.

**NARRATOR:** The ride to Mr. Bing's apartment was a little bumpy.

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**ARNIE:** *(tossed around)* Whoa! Whoooooaaa! *(trying his hardest to push the bag open)* Why does he keep me in this bag?

**NARRATOR:** Finally, the car came to a stop and they were home.

**MR. BING:** *(carefully removes Arnie from his paper bag and places him on a plate)*

**ARNIE:** *(wriggling around to see the plate)* What a handsome plate! I'm not crazy about the design. I prefer a more modern look.

**MR. BING:** *(lifts Arnie from the plate, humming in anticipation)*

**ARNIE:** Isn't that cute? *(closing his eyes and smiling)* He wants to hold me!

**MR. BING:** *(opens his mouth wide)*

**ARNIE:** *(opens eyes and screams)* What are you doing?! *(stretching arms and legs as wide as possible to prevent being eaten)*

**MR. BING:** *(shocked, he drops Arnie back on the plate)* I was going to . . . eat you.

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**ARNIE:** EAT ME?!! *(sprinkles flying everywhere)* Why would you do a thing like that? Do you make a habit of eating all your houseguests?!

**MR. BING:** No . . . of course not. [But] you're a doughnut. That's what doughnuts are for – to eat.

**ARNIE:** *(aghast)* Do you mean to tell me you've done this before?

**MR. BING:** *(sheepishly)* Yes . . . I eat a doughnut every day.

**NARRATOR:** *(to audience, frightened)* I'd better get out of here before he tries to eat me again! (then angry) My friends have probably all been eaten! *(thinks for a moment)* I must put a stop to this right away! I'll call the bakery and warn the others.

**NARRATOR:** Arnie knew there was no time to waste and he needed to be very sneaky in order to keep his plan from Mr. Bing.

**ARNIE:** *(to Mr. Bing in his sweetest voice)* Excuse me, sir, I don't believe we've been properly introduced. My name is Arnie. *(offers hand to shake after licking off a few sprinkles)*

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**MR. BING:** *(still trying to figure out what's going on, he stammers)* Um. . . hello . . . I'm Mr. Bing. It's nice to eat, I mean, ***meet*** you.

**ARNIE:** *(slyly and extra politely)* Mr. Bing, would you be a dear and allow me to use your telephone? *(Mr. Bing hands Arnie his phone and Arnie quickly dials – phone rings)*

**BAKER:** *(answering)* Downtown Bakery. . .

**ARNIE:** *(ominous music as Arnie interrupts, whispering frantically)* Mr. Bakerman! This is Arnie the doughnut. I was bought about 20 minutes ago by a man who goes by the name Mr. Bing!

**BAKER:** Yes, Arnie, what can I do for you?

**ARNIE:** I don't want to alarm you, but that man tried to eat me! And not only that – he claims to have eaten 100s of us! I'm going to make a run for it, but I wanted to warn you so if you see him coming into the bakery again, you can stop him!

**BAKER:** *(unconcerned)* That's why I make doughnuts – for people to eat.

**ARNIE:** *(gasps)* Are the other doughnuts aware of this arrangement?

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**BAKER:** *(yells to other doughnuts)* Do you doughnuts know you're going to be eaten?

**LONG JOHN:** *(pirate accent)* We know!

**FRENCH CRUELLER:** *(with French accent)* We're delicious! I don't blame them.

**ARNIE:** *(crushed, the phone drops from his hand)*

**NARRATOR:** Arnie forgot all about his plan to escape.

**ARNIE:** *(collapses onto the plate, looks up at Mr. Bing and mutters resignedly)* All right then, let's get this over with. Go ahead and eat me.

**MR. BING:** I wouldn't feel right about it now. *(Arnie sighs in relief)* But! Since I'm not going to eat you. I'll have to figure out something. I paid good money for you. I don't want to be wasteful.

**ARNIE:** *(spinning and whirling)* Do you need a ballroom dance partner?

**MR. BING:** I don't dance . . . I could use you as a pincushion.

**ARNIE:** *(wincing)* Ohhh, too painful! *(thinking)* Would you like me to entertain you at parties? *(singing)* "Doughnut make my brown eyes blue"

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**MR. BING:** I don't like throwing parties. *(thinking)* I need a new bowling ball. . . *(picks up Arnie and rolls him along the floor)*

**ARNIE:** *(woozy)* I could be your chauffeur, or I'd make a great body guard. *(assumes a fighting stance)*

**MR. BING:** You can't see over the steering wheel . . . [and] Who would you protect me from . . . a cookie?

**NARRATOR:** They were both completely out of ideas.

**MR. BING:** I'm sorry, Arnie, but it's clear that we can't agree on anything for you to do around here. *(beat)* I think it would be best if you found another home.

**ARNIE:** *(sadly, wiping tears from his eyes with the napkin)* Is it all right if I keep this napkin to pack up all my loose sprinkles? *(blows nose then gathers sprinkles)* I guess doughnuts really are only good for eating, aren't they? *(he leaves dejectedly)*

**NARRATOR:** He walked past the mailboxes and the apartment manager's office. But when Arnie reached the "NO DOGS ALLOWED" sign at the end of the driveway, Mr. Bing suddenly came up with a new idea.

**MR. BING:** *(running after him)* Arnie! Wait up! *(out of breath)* I can't believe I didn't think of this earlier!

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*(excited)* I've always wanted a dog, but could never have one. There's no sign that says "NO DOUGHNUTS ALLOWED" *(Arnie perks up)* Would you like to take walks and play fetch?

**ARNIE:** You bet I would!

**MR. BING:** Can you do trick, like rolling over?

**ARNIE:** Rolling over? Look at me – I was made for rolling over!

**MR. BING:** Arnie . . . will you be my doughnut-dog?

**ARNIE:** *Arf! Arf! Arf!* *(panting and jumping around)*

**NARRATOR:** From that moment on, Arnie and Mr. Bing were inseparable.

**ARNIE:** *Arf! Arf!* *(shakes like a dog, then picks up flying sprinkles)*

## SOURCE INFORMATION

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